سوالات درک مطلب سال ۱۴۰۴

پنجشنبه صبح

Passage One

The control of the deadly diseases of childhood is the greatest medical achievement in this century. Because of vaccines and antibiotics, many more children survive childhood than in the past. Because of better nutrition, today's children grow centimetres taller and kilos heavier than their parents. But for all that modern medicine has done to protect and nourish the child's body, very little has been done to assure him of an equally healthy mind. The number of emotionally disturbed and mentally ill children in the world is very high and growing larger all the time. Most children who are emotionally disturbed are autistic or schizophrenic. They are helplessly withdrawn from reality and exist in an inner world that is seldom penetrated by outsiders. They may sit alone for hours or even days, completely still and silent, seemingly unaware of the world around them. Many can neither feed nor dress themselves and withdraw from or react violently to any person's attempts to help them. Many are put in institutions once their families feel that there is nothing more they can do for them. There, they may stay for years or even, in some cases, for the rest of their lives. Although the specific causes of childhood mental disorders are not certain, psychiatrists feel that the disturbances arise as a result of three influences: physical and hereditary factors, forces within early family life, and stress brought about by modern life.

1. **It is inferred from the passage that modern medicine has ..... .**
   a) increased the number of diseases affecting children
   b) significantly contributed to childhood mortality rates
   c) improved physical health more than mental health
   d) had no effect on childhood mortality rates

2. **As to the relationship between physical health and mental health, the author believes that .....**
   a) less attention has been paid to children's mental health support
   b) physical health improvements have led to better mental health
   c) modern medicine has adequately addressed both physical and mental health
   d) mental health is more important than physical health for children

3. **As to the current state of mental health support for children, the author is ..... .**
   a) optimistic and satisfied with the progress made
   b) supportive of existing mental health programs
   c) indifferent and uninterested in mental and physical health
   d) concerned and critical of the lack of attention to mental health

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4. **The passage implies that childhood mental disorders ..... .**
   a) can be managed by environmental factors definitely
   b) are controlled through a combination of factors
   c) can primarily be treated by the family and relatives' support
   d) are a temporary phase that most children will grow out of it

5. **All of the following variables are stated to be responsible for mental problems of children except the ..... .**
   a) education they receive
   b) atmosphere in which they grow up
   c) worries and anxieties they face in life
   d) genetic and bodily factors

Passage Two

The decision to quit smoking initiates a remarkable series of positive physiological changes, many of which begin within minutes. A mere 20 minutes after cessation, heart rate and blood pressure begin to normalize. Within 12 hours, carbon monoxide levels in the bloodstream drop, enhancing the blood's capacity to transport oxygen efficiently. Over the subsequent weeks, circulatory function improves, and pulmonary capacity increases, making physical activity less taxing. The respiratory system starts to recover as cilia-microscopic structures responsible for clearing mucus and pathogens-regain their function, significantly lowering the risk of infection. The long-term benefits of quitting are even more profound. After one year, the risk of coronary heart disease is reduced by approximately 50%. By the five-year mark, the likelihood of stroke can equal that of someone who has never smoked. Moreover, the probability of developing cancers of the mouth, throat, bladder, and oesophagus continues to decline with each smoke-free year. A decade post-cessation, the mortality rate from lung cancer drops to roughly half that of a current smoker. After 15 years, cardiovascular risk approaches that of a lifelong non-smoker. Beyond internal health improvements, smoking cessation enhances one's appearance and sensory experience. Skin often regains its elasticity and tone, teeth may whiten, and the senses of taste and smell typically sharpen within days. In essence, quitting smoking is not merely a behavioural change it is a life-saving intervention with immediate and lasting effects on nearly every system of the body.

6. **In this passage, the author aims to ..... .**
   a) highlight the wide-ranging benefits of quitting smoking
   b) warn about the dangers of tobacco addiction for users
   c) compare different methods for quitting smoking
   d) describe how smoking affects physical appearance

7. **The author mentions 'cilia' in the passage to ..... .**
   a) explain why quitting smoking is difficult for some people
   b) describe long-term risks of cancer
   c) compare smokers and non-smokers
   d) show how the lungs clean themselves after quitting

8. **Which of the following statements is TRUE about the long-term effects of quitting smoking?**
   a) Stroke risk increases 10 years after it happens
   b) The appearance of the skin worsens, causing a lot of suffering
   c) The risk of lung cancer remains the same after five years
   d) Cardiovascular risk is like that of a non-smoker after 15 years

9. **According to this passage, smoking cessation ..... .**
   a) should only be attempted with medical supervision
   b) guarantees full recovery from all smoking-related damage
   c) leads to benefits, not all of which start immediately
   d) is mainly beneficial for younger individuals

10. **According to the passage, shortly after smoking cessation ..... .**
    a) the risk of heart disease disappears immediately
    b) the body begins to recover almost afterward
    c) lung damage is completely reversed
    d) energy levels drop temporarily

Passage Three

The placebo effect refers to an improvement in symptoms as a result of medical treatment with an inactive substance like a sugar pill or even a staged medical procedure such as surgery. In other words, a patient recovers even though there has been no genuine medical intervention. One of the most dramatic examples of the placebo effect involves a study of patients with acute arthritis knee pain. In an effort to determine which aspects of knee surgery were most effective, Dr. Bruce Moseley conducted a controlled experiment involving three groups. In the first group, surgery included shaving off thin layers of the damaged cartilage; in the second group, the doctor flushed out the knee joint and disposed of the unhealthy tissue. In the third group, he simulated surgery by anesthetizing the patients and making the necessary incision. However, no actual knee surgery was performed. In fact, the patients were not informed until a full two years afterwards that their operations were staged. The results were astonishing. While knee pain for all three groups diminished significantly, there was no difference in the level of pain decrease for any one group over another. Rather, the uniform results seemed to be mediated by the placebo effect or the patient's belief in the benefit of the surgical procedure. As one of the placebo patients, Tim Perez,

was later quoted as saying, "In this world anything is possible when you put your mind to it. I know that your mind can work miracles." Perez, who previously could only get around with the aid of a cane, is now able to shoot baskets with his grandchildren.

11. The results of Dr. Moseley's knee surgery study were considered surprising because ..... .

a) those undergoing simulated surgery and those having real surgical procedures got better alike
b) all the patients, even those who received real surgery, reported temporary alleviation of pain
c) the surgery procedures used were outdated and less effective than expected
d) the patients who knew about the staged surgeries still showed improvement

12. It is clear from the text that ..... is NOT an operation performed by Dr. Bruce Moseley.

a) making a surgical incision
b) replacing the knee joint
c) removing portions of the knee cartilage
d) using liquid to clear out damaged knee tissue

13. In the third group, patients were not told about the details of their surgical procedure until two years afterwards because the doctor ..... .

a) aimed to blind the patients about the treatment modality
b) was afraid he might face misconduct accusation
c) was concerned that they would react in anger
d) aimed to observe the principles of medical privacy

14. According to the text, it is NOT correct that ..... .

a) all patient groups experienced significant pain reduction
b) patients were immediately told they might receive placebo surgery
c) the placebo effect can produce dramatic physical improvements
d) the effectiveness of knee surgery for arthritis was examined

15. Based on Tim Perez's experience, ...

a) a positive attitude can sometimes create real improvements in physical conditions
b) placebo treatments can temporarily mask the symptoms without real healing
c) recovery from surgery depends entirely on external medical interventions
d) a strong belief in the effectiveness of treatment could prevent all future injuries

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Passage 4

Digital tools that collect data and support interventions outside the clinical setting offer meaningful opportunities to identify risks and engage patients (Consumer-facing apps and clinical monitors that actively or passively collect data can also serve as an early warning system for prevention and disease management. During the COVID-19 pandemic, digital contact tracing apps provided patients with notifications about potential exposure to COVID-19 Beyond COVID-19, some tools generate warnings to individuals or caregivers regarding changes in environmental risks, such as pollen or air pollution alerts, while other platforms generate alerts to patients, families, and providers in the event of disease exacerbation. Additionally, while not widely acceptable or accessible by all populations, use of remote patient monitoring (RPM) tools increased during the COVID-19 pandemic. RPM enables clinicians to assess symptoms for patients at home with mild cases of COVID-19 and observe non-COVID-19-related health outcomes in the context of daily living for patients with chronic conditions. Digital tools have also expanded care delivery for providers beyond the hospital or exam room. A 2020 analysis found that virtual urgent care visits could reduce the need for emergency room care by approximately 20%, and 20% of all office care, outpatient, and home health services could be delivered virtually or near-virtually. Non-acute care visits for many conditions were implemented virtually during the COVID-19 pandemic to reduce risk of exposure for patients and providers. Even with the sharp decline in telehealth in 2021-after the steep rise associated with COVID-19 in 2020-a review by a large payer in 2022 supported the value of virtual care.

16. According to the passage, one major function of consumer-facing apps and clinical monitors is that they ..... .

a) are primarily used to prescribe medication without a physician's input
b) help detect risks and engage patients before health problems arise
c) are designed mainly to replace in-person surgical procedures
d) focus on entertainment while patients recover from illnesses

17. During the COVID-19 pandemic, remote patient monitoring (RPM) ..... .

a) expanded in use to monitor both COVID-19 and non-COVID-19 health outcomes
b) became widely unpopular among clinicians and patients afflicted with COVID-19
c) was strongly banned for most patients afflicted with chronic conditions
d) replaced all forms of physical hospital care provided in hospital settings

18. The 2020 analysis concluded that virtual urgent care ..... .

a) increased emergency room visits significantly
b) should only be used for severe medical emergencies
c) decreased patient satisfaction with healthcare services
d) could cut the need for emergency room care by about one-fifth

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19. What can be inferred about the future role of virtual care based on the review by a large payer in 2022?

a) Virtual care will be a valuable part of healthcare delivery even after the pandemic
b) Virtual care will likely be phased out due to lack of effectiveness
c) All healthcare services will be eventually virtualized entirely
d) Virtual care will only be used for mental health services moving forward

20. According to the passage, digital tools on healthcare delivery have ..... .

a) increased the reliance on emergency departments
b) extended healthcare beyond traditional clinical settings
c) discouraged patients from participating in their own care
d) slowed down the adoption of new technologies in hospitals

پنجشنبه عصر

Passage One

Anxiety is a complex psychological condition that can disrupt daily life, often manifesting in excessive worry, physical tension, and a sense of impending doom. While it is a natural response to stress, chronic anxiety can lead to debilitating effects if not properly managed. Effective anxiety management involves a multifaceted approach that integrates cognitive, behavioural, and physiological strategies. Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT) is one of the most widely recognized therapeutic methods for managing anxiety. CBT helps individuals identify and challenge irrational thoughts that fuel anxious feelings. By reframing negative thought patterns, individuals can learn to respond more rationally to stressors. Additionally. mindfulness meditation has been shown to reduce anxiety by encouraging individuals to focus on the present moment, rather than thinking out past or future events. This practice promotes a state of awareness that helps break the cycle of worry. Physical techniques such as deep breathing exercises and progressive muscle relaxation are also essential. These practices activate the parasympathetic nervous system, reducing the body's stress response and inducing a feeling of calm. Regular physical exercise can also be highly effective, as it reduces the levels of cortisol, the stress hormone, and releases endorphins, which elevate mood. Furthermore, lifestyle adjustments such as adequate sleep, balanced nutrition, and a reduction in caffeine intake can alleviate symptoms. Recognizing the importance of social support is crucial, as maintaining meaningful connections can foster emotional resilience. Thus, managing anxiety requires a holistic approach, combining cognitive strategies, physical relaxation techniques, and lifestyle changes to restore balance and improve overall mental health.

21. The primary role of CBT in managing anxiety is ..... .

a) modifying irrational thought patterns
b) worsening physical responses to anxiety
c) encouraging mindfulness and relaxation
d) avoiding anxiety-provoking situations

22. Deep breathing and muscle relaxation techniques do all of the following Except ..... .

a) promoting a sense of calm
b) increasing the body's stress response
c) activating the parasympathetic nervous system
d) reducing physical stress caused by anxiety

23. Mindfulness meditation helps reduce anxiety by ..... .

a) focusing on future planning
b) suppressing all anxious thoughts
c) encouraging tendency for stressors
d) interrupting the mechanism of worry

24. Social support is important in managing anxiety because it ..... .

a) contradicts cognitive therapies like CBT
b) helps reduce physical tension
c) reinforces emotional resilience
d) provides a temporary distraction from anxiety

25. Which of the following factors contribute to reducing stress and anxiety through lowering cortisol?

a) nutrition and sleep
b) exercise
c) mindfulness
d) physical assessment

Passage Two

Social media has become integral to our daily routines: we interact with family members and friends, accept invitations to public events, and join online communities to meet people who share similar preferences using these platforms. Social media has opened a new avenue for social experiences since the early 2000s, extending the possibilities for communication. According to recent research, people spend 2.3 hours a daily on social media. Research shows excessive use is mainly associated with lower psychological well-being. However, findings also suggest that the quality rather than the quantity of social media use can determine whether the experience will

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enhance or deteriorate the user's mental health. Social media can provide opportunities to enhance the mental health of users by facilitating social connections and peer support. Indeed, online communities can provide a space for discussions regarding health conditions, adverse life events, or everyday challenges, which may decrease the sense of stigmatization and increase belongingness and perceived emotional support. Mutual friendships, rewarding social interactions, and humour on social media also reduced stress during the COVID-19 pandemic. On the other hand, several studies have pointed out the potentially detrimental effects of social media use on mental health. Concerns have been raised that social media may lead to body image dissatisfaction, increase the risk of addiction and cyber-bullying involvement, contribute to phobic behaviours, and negatively affects mood. Excessive use has increased loneliness, fear of missing out, and decreased subjective well-being and life satisfaction. Users at risk of social media addiction often report depressive symptoms and lower self-esteem.

26. The primary roles of social media in modern life is to ..... .

a) enhance professional success
b) create physical social gatherings
c) facilitate interactions among users
d) reduce communication among individuals

27. The positive or negative impacts of social media mental health depends on the ..... .

a) absence of face-to-face communication
b) total number of hours spent online
c) quality of social media engagement
d) number of online friends a user has

28. Which is NOT mentioned as a way social media can enhance mental health?

a) Offering financial assistance to users in need
b) Providing emotional support and peer connections
c) Creating a space for health-related discussions
d) Reducing the feeling of stigmatization and isolation

29. Which of the following is emphasized in the text?

a) A decline in professional achievements
b) An increased risk of cyber-bullying and addiction
c) Difficulty in understanding digital communication trends
d) A physical weakness due to lack of physical activity

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30. The text suggests that users at risk of social media addiction ..... .

a) experience depressive symptoms and lower self-esteem
b) typically develop strong real-life friendships
c) tend to avoid online interactions altogether
d) report an increase in overall well-being

Passage Three

Physiotherapy is a healthcare profession that helps people recover from injuries, illnesses, or disabilities through movement and exercise. It is commonly used to treat conditions such as back pain, joint problems, neurological disorders, and post-surgical recovery. Physiotherapists assess a patient's condition and create personalized treatment plans that may include stretching, strengthening exercises, massage, and specialized techniques like hydrotherapy or electrotherapy. The cost of physiotherapy can vary depending on several factors. One major factor is location. In some countries, physiotherapy services are covered by health insurance or public healthcare systems, making them affordable or even free for patients. However, in private clinics, prices may be higher. Another factor is the type of treatment required. Basic consultation and exercise therapy tend to be more affordable, while specialized treatments, such as manual therapy or advanced rehabilitation techniques, can be more expensive. On average, a single physiotherapy session can cost anywhere from $30 to $150, depending on the country and clinic. Some clinics offer package deals for multiple sessions, which can reduce the overall cost. Additionally, online physiotherapy consultations have become more common, often providing a more affordable option for those who cannot visit a clinic in person. Physiotherapy is an essential service that helps many individuals regain mobility, reduce pain, and improve their overall quality of life. While the cost can vary, many people find it a worthwhile investment in their health and well-being.

31. The primary goal of physiotherapy is to ..... through specialized techniques.

a) decrease the cost of body fitness and mobility
b) help individuals recover from body damage
c) prepare patients for surgical procedures
d) eliminate consultation sessions for body pain

32. All of the following is commonly treated by physiotherapy EXCEPT ..... .

a) Back pain
b) Joint problems
c) Neurological disorders
d) Preoperative complications

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33. Many people feel investment in the health and well-being is worth despite the fact that physiotherapy is ..... .

a) costly
b) futile
c) illogical
d) irrational

34. The variation in physiotherapy costs across different countries depends on the ..... .

a) availability of hydrotherapy in all clinics
b) inclusion of consultation in private clinics
c) inclusion of physiotherapy in healthcare systems
d) uniformity of treatment methods worldwide

35. Online physiotherapy consultations are of benefit to patients by ..... .

a) eliminating the need for any physical exercises
b) offering free services in all countries
c) providing a more affordable option
d) replacing all in-person physiotherapy sessions

Passage Four

Research shows that a significant proportion of health spending is attributed to chronic diseases, with individuals experiencing multiple comorbidities accounting for a disproportionate share of expenditures. Although additional research is necessary, a recent review concluded that self-management as part of a treatment program for patients with chronic conditions has small-to-moderate impacts on health behaviours, health outcomes, and service utilization and should be an ongoing priority in promoting population health. Thus, the market appetite and the necessity exist to facilitate diagnosis, reduce disease burden, and improve care for those who experience chronic disease. To address these problems, innovators, software vendors, payers, and government regulators are investing heavily in digital health solutions for diagnosis and treatment, with particular attention to high-need, high-cost populations. An example of a diagnostic tool enhanced by digital health includes smartphone-based photoplethysmography (using a smartphone camera to capture video from the subject's index fingertip), combined with a deep neural network, a form of artificial intelligence (AI), to detect diabetes. While not widely adopted, such tools could be used for self- administered, low-cost, widespread screening. Al is also used in radiology and pathology to augment human interpretation of diagnostic (e.g, ocular, X-ray, or magnetic resonance imaging) and pathology slide images, supporting potentially more accurate and timely diagnosis and individualized treatment plans for various cancers and renal diseases. Drug researchers and manufacturers are also leveraging various forms of Al for patient recruitment,

virtual engagement, and literature review, and using the technologies to assist in detecting and refining pharmaceutical targets.

36. According to the passage, why are digital health tools gaining investment and attention?

a) they have completely replaced traditional diagnostic techniques
b) they eliminate the need for human doctors in diagnosis and treatment
c) they focus mainly on cosmetic health improvements rather thar serious illnesses
d) they allow for widespread self-screening and improved care for chronic diseases

37. What role docs artificial intelligence (AI) play in modern diagnostic processes?

a) Al supports interpretation of diagnostic images to improve accuracy
b) Al independently diagnoses and treats diseases without human input
c) Al is used to create entirely new types of diseases for research
d) Al replaces laboratory tests by using patient interviews alone

38. What impact did a recent review find regarding self-management programs for chronic disease patients?

a) They had no measurable impact on health behaviors
b) They showed small-to-moderate improvements in health outcomes
c) They significantly eliminated the need for medical services
d) They made chronic diseases worse in most cases

39. What can be inferred from the future use of smartphone-based photoplethysmography?

a) It is already the primary tool used for diabetes diagnosis
b) It will likely be abandoned due to its complexity and high costs
c) It is intended only for research purposes and not for general public use
d) It holds potential for affordable mass screening in the future

40. In the sentence "While not widely adopted, such tools could be used for self-administered, low- cost, widespread screening," what does "such tools" refer to?

a) Smartphone-based photoplethysmography combined with Al
b) Pharmaceutical targets refined by researchers
c) Traditional X-ray machines used in hospitals
d) Government regulations on digital health

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جمعه صبح

Passage One

Immunization efforts are under growing threat as misinformation, population growth, humanitarian crises and funding cuts jeopardize progress and leave millions of children, adolescents and adults at risk, warm WHO, UNICEF, and Gavi. Outbreaks of vaccine-preventable diseases such as measles, meningitis and yellow fever are rising globally, and diseases like diphtheria, which have long been held at bay or virtually disappeared in many countries, are at risk of re-emerging. In response, the agencies are calling for urgent and sustained political attention and investment to strengthen immunization programs and protect significant progress achieved in reducing child mortality over the past 50 years. Measles is making an especially dangerous comeback. The increasing number of cases since 2021 result from the reductions in immunization coverage that occurred since the CÖVID-19 pandemic in many communities. Measles cases reached an estimated 10.3 million in 2023, a 20% increase compared to 2022. Meningitis cases in Africa also rose sharply in 2024, and the upward trend has continued into 2025. In the first three months of this year alone, more than 5500 suspected cases and nearly 300 deaths were reported in 22 countries. This follows approximately 26000 cases and almost 1400 deaths across 24 countries last year. As part of integrated primary health-care systems, vaccination can protect against diseases and connect families to other essential care, such as antenatal care, nutrition or malaria screening. Immunization is a "best buy' in health with a return on investment of $54 for every dollar invested and provides a foundation for future prosperity and health security. UNICEF, WHO, and Gavi urgently call for parents, the public, and politicians to strengthen support for immunization.

41. What is the primary concern expressed by WHO, UNICEF, and Gavi during World Immunization Week?

a) Increased public interest in vaccine-preventable diseases
b) The need to develop new vaccines for emerging diseases
c) The rising threat to immunization progress due to various global challenges
d) A shortage of vaccine investment and policy attention in developing countries

42. According to the passage, which disease has shown a particularly dangerous return since 2021?

a) Measles
b) Meningitis
c) Diphtheria
d) Yellow fever

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43. The economic argument in favor of investing in immunization maintains that it ..... .

a) reduces the need for international aid
b) offers a significant return on investment
c) triples the investment within two years
d) helps lower educational costs globally

44. It can be inferred about the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic on immunization coverage that ..... .

a) it had no noticeable effect on vaccination rates
b) it led to improvements in immunization tracking methods
c) it eliminated the need for traditional vaccination programs
d) it caused cuts in immunization coverage, increasing disease outbreaks

45. In the sentence "This follows approximately 26000 cases and almost 1400 deaths across 24 countries last year," "This" refers to ..... .

a) The spread of yellow fever in 2024
b) The rise in meningitis cases in 2025
c) The increase in measles cases since 2021
d) The number of humanitarian crises globally

Passage Two

Caring for the elderly presents several important challenges that affect families, healthcare systems, and society as a whole. Many older adults suffer from chronic health conditions such as arthritis, diabetes, high blood pressure, and dementia, all of which require regular monitoring, medication, and personal care. These conditions often limit mobility and independence, making daily tasks like bathing, cooking, or even walking difficult. Unfortunately, there is often a shortage of trained caregivers, and many family members are unprepared to manage these responsibilities. Providing care without proper training can lead to mistakes, emotional stress, and burnout. In addition to physical health, emotional and social needs must also be addressed. Elderly individuals frequently face loneliness and depression, especially if they live alone, have lost friends or a spouse, or feel disconnected from society. These feelings can negatively affect both mental and physical health. Financial challenges also make elderly care more complicated. Long-term care can be expensive, and not all families have access to quality insurance or government support. Many must choose between affordability and the level of care needed. Another key issue is respecting the dignity and independence of elderly individuals. While they may need help, it is important to involve them in decisions about their lives and health whenever possible. Balancing safety with personal freedom requires sensitivity and respect. These various challenges highlight

the growing need for stronger support systems, more caregiver training, better public awareness, and affordable services to meet the complex and changing needs of the aging population.

46. The author highlights various challenges of elderly care to ..... .

a) criticize current caregiving quality and practices
b) discourage families from providing care at home
c) advocate for systemic improvements and increased support
d) argue for reducing government involvement in elderly care

47. It appears that ..... has/have a domino effect on other aspects of elderly care.

a) economic obstacles
b) chronic health conditions
c) independence of elderly conditions
d) the need for personal independence

48. According to this passage, family caregivers experience burnout because they ..... .

a) are unwilling to care for aging relatives
b) prefer institutional care over home care
c) often lack the training needed for the caregiving role
d) receive much assistance from professional caregivers

49. Involving elderly individuals in decision-making is emphasized in the text ..... .

a) to reduce the workload of caregivers
b) to maintain their sense of respect and autonomy
c) because they often disagree with medical advice
d) so that they can avoid moving into care centres

50. As to the relationship between physical and emotional health in the elderly, it can be inferred that ..... .

a) physical health gets worsened before emotional health in aging individuals
b) physical and emotional health are independent challenges in elderly care
c) addressing physical health automatically resolves emotional issues
d) emotional well-being can impact physical health in older adults

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Passage Three

The ubiquity of microplastics, tiny plastic fragments less than 5 mm in diameter, has triggered global concern, particularly regarding their potential impact on human health. Detected in food, water, and even the air we breathe, these particles have been found in human tissues, from lungs to placentas. But what does this mean for our well-being? Some researchers warn that microplastics may act as carriers for harmful substances, such as heavy metals. or persistent organic pollutants. Once inside the body, these chemicals could disrupt hormonal balance or contribute to chronic inflammation. Although alarming, much of the current evidence comes from animal studies or controlled lab settings, making it difficult to determine actual effects in human populations. On the other hand, skeptics argue that the level of exposure most people face is relatively low, and that media-driven fears often outpace scientific findings. They emphasize the absence of definitive proof linking microplastics to specific health disorders. Furthermore, they caution against drawing strong conclusions from early-stage research, suggesting that public anxiety might be premature. Nevertheless, both sides agree on the necessity of further investigation. With plastic production still increasing worldwide, understanding the long-term implications of microplastic exposure remains a pressing issue. Whether the threat proves to be serious or overstated, the debate highlights a broader question: how much environmental contamination are we willing to tolerate before taking action?

51. The most suitable title for this passage would be "Microplastics and ..... .

a) the History of Synthetic Materials
b) the Debate Over Their Health Risks
c) the Global Demand for Their Restrictions
d) the Discovery of a Medical Breakthrough

52. According to the passage, one reason some scientists hesitate to raise alarms about microplastics is the current lack of ..... in human-based research.

a) public tendency
b) political interest
c) financial support
d) definitive evidence

53. The phrase "media-driven fears often outpace scientific findings" implies that the public's concern about microplastics may be based more on ..... than on conclusive data.

a) reliable evidence
b) government research
c) public health initiatives.
d) news exaggeration

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54. The author's tone throughout the passage can best be described as ..... showing concern without fully endorsing either side.

a) biased and emotional
b) dismissive and sarcastic
c) precautious and balanced.
d) indifferent and detached

55. It can be inferred that the author includes the final question in order to emphasize society's ..... toward environmental contamination.

a) dependence
b) endurance
c) ignorance
d) rejection

Passage Four

Telehealth has emerged as a promising solution for increasing access to medical care in rural and underserved communities. Through video consultations, remote monitoring, and digital diagnostics, patients in isolated areas can now connect with specialists who would otherwise be hundreds of miles away. Supporters argue that telehealth reduces barriers, cuts travel costs, and saves critical time-especially in emergencies or for those with chronic conditions. Yet, while the technology has clear advantages, it's not without limitations. Skeptics point to the digital divide: the lack of high-speed internet, limited digital literacy, and unreliable infrastructure in some communities make telehealth difficult, if not impossible, to implement equitably. Moreover, some healthcare providers warn that telehealth cannot fully replace in- person visits, particularly for physical exams or complex diagnoses. Still, others argue that dismissing telehealth because of these challenges overlooks its transformative potential. They advocate for investment in digital infrastructure, training, and policy reforms to bridge these gaps, seeing telehealth not as a replacement, but as a complement to traditional care. As digital solutions continue to evolve, it is likely that telehealth will become an increasingly integral part of healthcare delivery-especially for populations historically left behind by conventional systems. If addressed thoughtfully, today's limitations may eventually give way to a more connected and equitable model of care.

56. According to the passage, one reason telehealth can be ineffective in some communities is the lack of ..... .

a) reliable internet access
b) hospital infrastructure
c) private digital plans
d) healthcare facility

57. The phrase "digital divide" most probably refers to ..... .

a) variety in employment opportunities
b) personalized patient treatment plans
c) difficulty in implementing health policies equitably
d) insufficiency of online access and technological skills

58. It can be inferred that advocates of telehealth view it as ..... .

a) an unsafe shift in medical practice
b) a complete substitute for traditional care
c) a useful addition to in-person healthcare
d) a short-term solution with little long-term value

59. The conclusion of the passage predicts that telehealth will likely ..... in future models of healthcare delivery.

a) disappear as in-person care improves
b) become more central and widespread
c) be replaced by newer, non-digital systems
d) remain critical for underserved communities

60. One of the concerns raised by critics is that telehealth might ..... in diagnosing complex medical issues.

a) fall short
b) lower wait times
c) continue to evolve
d) overlook digital infrastructures

جمعه عصر

Passage One

Years of investment in the development and deployment of new malaria vaccines and next-generation tools to prevent and control malaria are paying off. On world malaria day, Mali will join 19 other African countries in introducing malaria vaccines a vital step towards protecting young children from one of the continent's most deadly diseases. The large-scale rollout of malaria vaccines in Africa is expected to save tens of thousands of young lives every year. Meanwhile, the expanded use of a new generation of insecticide-treated nets is poised to lower the disease burden. According to the latest World malaria report, these new nets which have greater impact against malaria than the standard pyrethroid-only nets-accounted for nearly 80% of all nets delivered in Sub-Saharan Africa in 2023, up from 59% the previous year. Despite significant gains, malaria remains a major public health challenge, with nearly 600 000 lives lost to the disease in 2023 alone. The African Region is hardest hit, shouldering an estimated 95% of the malaria burden each year. In many areas, progress

has been hampered by fragile health systems and rising threats such as drug and insecticide resistance. Many at-risk groups continue to miss out on the services they need to prevent, detect, and treat malaria. Climate change, conflict, poverty, and population displacement are compounding these challenges. WHO recently warned that the 2025 funding cuts could further derail progress in many endemic countries, putting millions of additional lives at risk. Of the 64 WHO country offices in malaria-endemic countries that took part in a recent WHO stock take assessment, more than half reported moderate or severe disruptions to malaria services.

61. Mali's introduction of malaria vaccines on world malaria day ..... .

(a) tends to protect children from a deadly disease
b) marks the first use of malaria vaccines globally
c) highlights the failure of malaria prevention tools
d) significantly marks the end of malaria in Africa

62. New generation insecticide-treated nets ..... .

a) had less impact against malaria than standard pyrethroid-only nets
b) declined in distribution significantly compared to previous years
c) were delivered in large numbers across Sub-Saharan Africa
d) were used in Mali despite limited use in many selected countries

63. The primary challenge(s) in combating malaria in Africa is (are) the ..... .

a) overuse of insecticide-treated nets in communities
b) weak healthcare systems and resistance threats
c) lack of vaccines and preventive measures
d) low awareness and limited research efforts

64. As to the 2025 funding cuts, the WHO warned that they could ..... .

a) disrupt progress and put millions of lives at risk
b) increase the delivery of insecticide-treated nets
c) improve malaria services in endemic countries
d) lead to the eradication of malaria

65. Which statement best summarizes the main idea of the text?

a) Malaria vaccines treated nets have eradicated the disease
b) Malaria is no longer a concern in Africa due to vaccine challenge
c) Malaria remains a challenge despite medical advancements
d) Funding cuts will have few impacts on malaria prevention efforts

Passage Two

Climate change, a critical public health issue in 2024, significantly affects mental health, an emerging concern for global communities. Extreme weather events like wildfires, hurricanes, and heat waves trigger acute psychological distress, including anxiety and post-traumatic stress disorder, particularly in affected regions. Long-term environmental shifts, such as rising sea levels and prolonged droughts, foster chronic conditions like depression and eco-anxiety, especially among vulnerable groups such as indigenous populations and low-income coastal residents. Research indicates that extended heat exposure worsens mood disorders, while climate-induced displacement increases risks of social isolation and substance abuse. Public health systems are responding with innovative solutions, such as teletherapy services for remote communities, community-based resilience workshops, and mental health integration into disaster relief efforts. However, challenges like limited funding, persistent stigma around mental health, and insufficient training for providers impede its progress. Effective responses require global collaboration among policymakers, mental health experts, and environmental scientists to develop adaptive strategies and ensure equitable access to care. In this regard, grassroots initiatives are empowering communities to build psychological resilience through local support groups and education. In addition, public health campaigns play a vital role in reducing stigma and promoting coping strategies, such as mindfulness and community support networks.

66. Long-term climate change affects meatal health by ..... .

a) causing only acute stressors
b) excluding mood disorders
c) impacting only remote areas
d) leading to chronic conditions

67. The mental health effects of climate change ..... .

a) are restricted to severe stress
b) include anxiety and depression
c) overlook vulnerable communities
d) are limited to community populations

68. The challenges in tackling climate-related mental health issues are ..... .

a) funding and stigma barriers
b) limited to technological issues
c) lingering educational concerns
d) restricted to policy-making

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69. Teletherapy services ..... .

a) train healthcare providers
b) focus on urban populations
c) serve remote communities
d) replace resilience workshops

70. Grassroots initiatives ..... .

a) are ineffective in rural areas
b) build resilience through support
c) replace disaster relief efforts
d) eliminate mental health issues

Passage Three

The increasing use of artificial intelligence in manuscript publishing presents significant ethical concerns that must be carefully addressed. Al-powered tools assist in editing, content generation, and peer review, the publishing process. However, these advancements raise important questions streamlining about authorship, originality, and transparency. One key ethical concern is the integrity of authorship. Al-generated content blurs the line between human creativity and machine assistance. If an AI contributes significantly to a manuscript, should it be credited as an author? Or should researchers disclose its involvement? Failure to properly acknowledge Al's role may mislead readers about the origins of the work. Additionally, Al models trained on existing literature might inadvertently reproduce biases present in historical research. This raises concerns about fairness, diversity, and the accuracy of Al-generated recommendations in publishing decisions. Ethical publishing requires human oversight to prevent AI from reinforcing existing inequalities or favoring dominant perspectives. Another critical issue is transparency in Al-driven editorial processes. If peer-review systems rely on automated assessments, authors may question the fairness of evaluations. AI cannot fully grasp the nuances of innovative research, and its decisions could lack accountability. Therefore, publishers must implement safeguards, ensuring that Al complements rather than replaces human judgment. While Al offers efficiency and innovation in manuscript publishing, its ethical implications must be carefully managed. Responsible usage involves clear disclosure, bias mitigation, and maintaining the integrity of academic publishing. Striking the right balance ensures that AI serves as a valuable tool without compromising ethical standards in scholarly work.

71. When AI tools significantly contribute to manuscript writing and editing, concerns about the ..... arise.

a) question of authorship and proper attribution
b) potential for increased efficiency in publishing
c) reduction of human involvement in peer review
d) ability to detect plagiarism more effectively

72. AI-powered peer review systems can unintentionally introduce ethical challenges by ..... .

a) reducing the speed of manuscript evaluations
b) maintaining biases present in training data
c) increasing transparency in decision-making
d) eliminating the need for human reviewers

73. If AI significantly contributes to a manuscript without proper acknowledgment, it ..... .

a) may boost the originality of the manuscript
b) ensures fairness in the publishing process
c) eliminates the need for human oversight
d) could deceive readers about the origin of the work

74. AI models trained on historical research data inadvertently affect publishing decisions by ..... .

a) ensuring diversity in recommendations.
b) eliminating the need for human oversight
c) providing biases present in historical research
d) accurately identifying innovative research

75. Transparency in AI-driven editorial processes is critical because it ..... .

a) ensures full replacement of human judgment by AI
b) addresses concerns about the fairness of automated evaluations
c) eliminates the need for safeguards in publishing
d) allows AI to grasp the nuances of innovative research

Passage Four

Balance is critical to successful aging, as studies have found that poor balance is associated with an increased risk of falls, nursing home admission, and mortality. Balance is regulated by multiple systems, including the visual system, the vestibular system, and the proprioceptive system. Studies have reported that the visual system takes on a more important role in maintaining postural control in older age. Yet, visual impairment becomes much more common in older age, which may leave visually impaired older adults without adequate postural control. Many cross-sectional studies have indicated a relationship between impaired vision and worse balance. For example, many population-based studies have reported an association between various measures of visual function (e.g., visual acuity, visual field, motion detection threshold) and balance problems. Other clinical research studies have found that patients with glaucoma, cataract, or age-related macular degeneration (AMD) had worse balance. All of these studies have been cross-sectional in design, which can lead to reverse

causality. To our knowledge, only 3 longitudinal studies have reported on vision and the onset of balance problems. Two of them have shown no association, while 1 found an association between visual impairment and the onset of a composite mobility measure that included balance. There is a need for more longitudinal data that examine this issue. Data from the Canadian Longitudinal Study on Aging (CLSA) provide an opportunity to investigate how visual impairment or eye diseases are associated with the risk of developing balance problems.

76. The primary reason that balance becomes more challenging with age is ..... .

a) A decline in the vestibular system's function due to aging
b) Increased reliance on vision while other systems weaken
c) Development of neurological disorders and diseases
d) Lack of opportunities to do physical exercises

77. Cross-sectional studies on vision and balance might be problematic as ..... .

a) They focus exclusively on younger populations
b) They involve too few participants to be statistically valid
c) They ignore the role of the proprioceptive system entirely
d) They cannot determine whether vision loss causes balance issues or vice versa

78. By "reverse causality", the writer means the cause(s) of impaired balance ..... .

a) is the old age alone
b) are various measures of visual function
c) are glaucoma, cataract, and AMD
d) is impaired vision only

79. According to the text, the writer believes that ..... .

a) Longitudinal studies are better than cross-sectional studies
b) Longitudinal studies are only good to investigate balance problems
c) One longitudinal study is enough to investigate the issue of balance
d) More longitudinal studies are required to investigate the issue of balance

80. According to the text, it is CORRECT that ..... .

a) poor balance only affects mobility but not mortality risk
b) the proprioceptive system becomes dominant for balance in old age
c) visual impairment prevalence increases with advancing age
d) only two systems regulate balance in humans

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